

Michael Ketigian

Brand and messaging strategist, engineer by training

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Brand and content consultant, operations leader and poet. Combines technical fluency with clear writing and experience leading teams to deliver client work.

Professional experience

2020–present Remote	Symantic Studio Owner/Operator, Independent Consultant - Brand, content and product strategy and copywriting. Technology clients include Astroscale, Ursa Major, Matter Venture Partners, Meritech Capital, Merlyn Mind, OfferFit, Civic and Veryfi. - Everyday Dose, 2021–2026 recurring engagements: brand/messaging lead and operations for the functional coffee company.
2018–2019 Remote	Good Market Project Manager, Operations Sourced and managed a distributed software development team to launch a nonprofit digital marketplace for people-and-planet-first businesses.
2016–2018 Colombo	Independent Consultant Branding, Writing & Operations Branding and copywriting, freelance journalism, and the launch and management of a coworking space with a local partner.
2013–2015 New York	Hackerati Director of Operations Led business development, marketing, recruiting and events, reporting to the cofounders. The software consultancy served Huffington Post, Viacom, SMEs and startups. Led Agile engineering and design teams as a Scrum-certified project manager. Coordinated and presented at two UN events.
2012 New York	Mini-Circuits RF & Microwave Engineer Developed and tested RF and microwave components for a global manufacturer.

Education

2012 New York	The Cooper Union for the Advancement of Science and Art Bachelor of Science in Engineering Focus on electrical engineering and integrated systems. Full-tuition scholarship · Dean's List
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Areas of practice

Brand and content strategy · Copywriting · Business development · Operations · Engineering team management · Agile project delivery · Public speaking and performance · AI workflow design

Independent AI systems work

2026

Lisbon

neXus

Independent project, product owner & architect

Directs AI agents as an engineering team to develop an orchestration and project-management system. Sets goals, designs workflows and verifies results; agents write the code.

- Experiments with multi-provider continuity, local voice interaction, session tracking and records of which agent produced work.
- Studies failures in everyday use, including incomplete work reported as finished and drift from instructions, and tests human oversight and review processes.

Selected performances & talks

Poetry and rap at technology, climate and impact forums, 2014-present. Turns complex ideas and live discussions into language an audience can follow.

Jan 2025

Climate Hub, Davos

"Regenerative Roadshow," a performative keynote led by Chad Frischmann of Project Drawdown and RegenIntel. Served as his rap translator.

2019

UN General Assembly

Opening rap at the SDG Action Zone and Rap Up at the SDG Media Zone, New York.

2016

TEDxColombo

"Unleash Your Inner Artist," Colombo, Sri Lanka.

2020

UN General Assembly

Composed a live Rap Up during the main Digital Cooperation event and performed it as the closing.

2019

IDEA Week, Notre Dame

Moderated a blockchain and entrepreneurship panel. Performed a Rap Up opening for Bill Nye.

Selected work

Selected client work

Brand and content work for technology companies at michaelxmachina.com/work/.